# Surface preparation & finishes

National 5 · Machines, materials & finishing · Worksheet

WOODWORK WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**By the end of this worksheet I can…**

- ☐ prepare a surface by planing, scraping, stopping and sanding
- ☐ choose a suitable finish: varnish, stain, wax or oils
- ☐ apply a finish evenly to every surface

## I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

*A pine coffee table is to be stained and varnished.*

**1 Describe the stages of preparing the surface before finishing.** (3 marks)

**Full-mark answer** each ✓ is one mark

Plane the surface smooth with a smoothing plane and scrape any torn grain with a cabinet scraper ✓. Fill any small holes with stopper and let it dry ✓. Sand with the grain using glasspaper on a cork block, working from coarse to medium to fine, then dust off ✓.

**Why marks are not awarded**

*"Sand it and then varnish it."*

1 mark at most: sanding without the order of grades or direction.

## WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

*A pupil wants to darken a pine shelf.*

**2 Explain an advantage of stain over varnish for this.** (1 mark)

**Sentence starters**

One reason is … because …

Another reason is … so …

**Word bank**

changes · colour · Stain

Tip: 1 marks = 1 separate, developed points.

**YOU DO** **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

### 3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

**a)** What does stain do?
☐ Protects the wood from water ☐ Changes the colour of the wood ☐ Fills holes ☐ Hardens the surface

**b)** Which finish is food-safe for a chopping board?
☐ Varnish ☐ Vegetable oil ☐ Stain ☐ Wax polish with solvent

**c)** In what order should abrasive paper be used?
☐ Fine to coarse ☐ Coarse to fine ☐ Medium only ☐ Any order

**d)** What is "stopping"?
☐ Removing tear-out with a scraper ☐ Filling small holes and cracks ☐ Sanding the end grain ☐ Applying the last coat

### 4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. **Order of abrasive grades** | ____ | **A** Garnet is harder and lasts longer |
| 2. **Sanding direction** | ____ | **B** With the grain |
| 3. **Stopping** | ____ | **C** Filling small holes or cracks with wood stopper |
| 4. **Scraping** | ____ | **D** Using a cabinet scraper to remove tears and plane marks |
| 5. **Garnet paper vs glass paper** | ____ | **E** Changes colour but doesn't protect: needs varnish or wax on top |
| 6. **Stain** | ____ | **F** Coarse, then medium, then fine |

*A beech salad bowl has been turned.*

### 5 Name a suitable finish and give a reason. (2 marks)

*A cabinet scraper is being used on an oak top.*

### 6 State the name of this process and what it does. (2 marks)

### Check and reflect

Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?